STATE PENSION · THE MISSING YEARS

Worked in the UK, but not in every year?

The State Pension is counted in years, not in how much you earned. A year with no National Insurance — the contribution taken out of your pay — is a gap in your pension. And you can pay to fill it.

WHAT A YEAR COSTS AT THE 2026-27 RATE

£18.40

Class 3 is **£18.40** a week in 2026 to 2027 — **£956.80** for a whole year. If you were self-employed with small profits, Class 2 is **£3.65** a week.

> You can only pay for the past **6** tax years, by 5 April. Older years are at today's rate. Class 3 for the last two years, and Class 2 for the last year, are at their own year's rate.

WHO DOES NOT NEED TO PAY

10 years

Under **10** years on your record you get no new State Pension — but years you pay for now count towards those 10. And at **35** years, on a record started after April 2016, it is already full.

> You cannot pay at all with no gaps, or past the deadline. And GOV.UK says voluntary contributions "do not always increase your State Pension" — check your forecast first.

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Not sure how many years you have paid?

Message us and we will go through your National Insurance record with you. No obligation.

0330 133 1886

General information. For your own situation, speak to an accountant.